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MODULE 6.3

Competition and the Four *Questions*

A crowded product is not automatically dead. There is a framework for deciding when to push through and when to walk.

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Competition and the *Four Questions*

The last thing to check before committing is how many people are already running the product.

Search the product on TikTok and see how many accounts are running it. **If only one person is on it, that is an excellent sign** and there is room to come in and do well. As a general threshold, if more than about three people are already running the same product the same way, it gets much harder to stand out by copying them directly.

But a crowded product is not automatically dead. This is where strategy comes in. If several competitors are already on a product, ask yourself **four questions**.

1

"Is there a new angle?"

A different audience or niche that would also want this product that nobody has targeted yet. **A quick way to generate ideas:** ask an AI assistant what other passionate niches or audiences would want this type of product, then see which suggestions actually make sense.

2

"Is there a new concept or content format?"

If everyone is using the same content style, being the first to bring a different one, like **an emotional angle when everyone else is doing a straight showcase**, can make you stand out and spread.

3

"Is there a new platform?"

If the competitors are all only on one or two platforms and ignoring others, you can be the first to bring the product to **an untapped platform** and take that audience.

4

"Is there a new country?"

Taking a proven product into a market where nobody is running it makes you first there. **This is more advanced**, and the caution is that the product and its audience have to actually make sense for that country. Do not move a product into a market where the underlying audience does not exist.

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"If you can find at least one of those four, the product is worth pursuing even with competition."

If you cannot find any of them, it is usually better to let it go and find something with more open opportunity. **The people who make the most are not doing what everyone else is doing.** They are finding the gap that lets them stand out before the product saturates.

Red ocean, blue ocean, purple ocean

A useful way to think about competition.

Red Ocean

A saturated market where everyone is running the same thing. Bloody. But also **validated**: if everyone is on it, it works.

Blue Ocean

Untapped. Nobody running it yet. Open water. The upside is huge. The risk is you are taking **more of a bet**.

Purple Ocean

A validated product, marketed in a new angle. Your own carved-out space inside a proven market. **The best of both.**

It might seem like you should always avoid the red ocean, but **a saturated product is actually validated**. If everyone is running it, it works. The way to win in a red ocean is flexibility, meaning a product that can be marketed in different angles. You take the validated, saturated product and you carve out a small piece of the market by marketing it differently than everyone else. **That puts you in your own space, the purple ocean.** Saturation tells you the product works. Flexibility is what lets you take that proven product somewhere new.

PATTERN TO INTERNALIZE

Many of the strongest products are **not brand new inventions**. They are proven winners taken to a new audience or given a new variant. Someone takes a product that already sold well in one niche and brings it to a different passionate niche, or releases a fresh variation of it. Because the product and the audience are both already proven, the combination tends to perform, and because they are first to that specific pairing, they have a much better chance of going viral.